

04-02 Meeting: District 10 AA Combined Committee

2026-04-02 19:00:48

Speaker 1

We that is live now. Um, so it was based off of a Pod token, but I don't like public AIs. I don't trust them. So I built my own home run AI to run it on.

Speaker 2

I'm Sitting in the hall. Dawn, she couldn't make it. She was sick. I'm an alternate CPI, and she's the new CPI at this conference, so she needs some help.

Speaker 1

And I've been helping her by what else? If we don't want to worry about that, this will register voices as attendance and automate all of that for us.

Speaker 3

Huge thing. But I don't have to do it as mine. Yeah, because last week. not last week, last month periodically.

Speaker 4

Yeah. Like call Dennis, thank you so much for the call. Okay, thank you. Yep, and pull it all out straight through meeting tonight.

Speaker 2

All right. I'm not getting a teacher.

Speaker 5

I have one from two years ago. You ready? Yep,

Speaker 1

That's all right. We're two minutes late. Good evening, everyone! That's something nice, right? We're going to open the meeting with the Serenity Prayer: God.

Speaker 6

Grant me the serenity to accept the things.

Speaker 7

I cannot change. Courage to change the things I can,

Speaker 1

And the wisdom to know the difference. All right, Last month, we had our first

meeting with the new secretary and treasurer and all. I sent out the meeting minutes, new setup, we got the website up and running. To get those minutes to everybody, can I get a motion to approve minutes from last month?

Speaker 3

Yeah, I'm proof.

Speaker 1

There we go. All in favor? Absolutely. Thanks. All right, so who wants to start us off with our GSR reports?

Speaker 1

Yeah, One by one as we go around. Yep. Okay, cool. Well, I'm Matt Alcoholic. I'm the GSR for Tuesday and Friday's Awakening the Pumpkin Church. Uh all of our positions are full. We're as always heavily fluctuating on membership. Home group stays about the same, ten people, but some meetings we have seven of us, some meetings there's like thirty five to forty. It all kind of depends on the day. Um I don't think we have any big meeting news or anything coming up. Um We did get the uh group numbers merged.

Speaker 1

It was a headache, But uh I finally got a hold of national office to get that taken care of. No, thank you for allowing me to serve. Thanks, Matt.

Speaker 3

Hi, I am Jane. I am an old time DCM. Hi Jane Jay.

Speaker 7

Oh, I am Ellen and I am an alcoholic. Hi Ellen and the GSR for theum Monday Corey closed discussion group.

Speaker 7

The only position in our group that's not filled is the grapevine, correct? But we always have somebody stepping in and doing it. Um, let's see. I don't our attendance is pretty much the same; it's somewhere around ten people. Our last meeting of the month is a big book, and for some reason that one's always smaller.

Speaker 3

We had thirty people last time, did we? Try to do that in my head.

Speaker 7

Um, what else? I think that's about it. We just made a donation. So, um, yeah, I think that's it. So.

Speaker 8

My name is Jim and I'm an alcoholic. The GSR for Clinton Monday night and the alternate for Clinton Saturday night. Saturday night's going really well. We have

attendance of around 12 to 18. People usually uh, all positions are filled. There. Monday night is a fairly small group. Uh sometimes we have four sometimes. We have as many as nine. And this is the this is the secretary and treasurer, the only meetings we have filled with. Things are going good. The bills are paid. Thanks, Tim. Thanks, Tim.

Speaker 9

Thanks for theum night when his sorority place meeting with a church down there?

Speaker 4

Which our attendance is.

Speaker 9

It's the same six of us every week. Well, at least that holding study. Um, we have a GSR treasurer and a secretary. Um, those are our positions we have and they're all filled.

Speaker 1

Awesome, thank you. Thank you.

Speaker 6

My Name is Suzanne I'm a grateful alcoholic. I am your treasurer.

Speaker 2

All right? District 10 District 10 Congratulations Thanks Alcoholic Dennis Lee Kalish I'm here for. Interest party, I've been helping Dawn at the CPI position. I attend both districts ten and eleven. I am a GSR in district eleven. I am also the alternate CPI, So I was here tonight to help Dawn and she's under the weather so she couldn't make it.

Speaker 5

Appreciate you being here, thanks. Joe Kenmok coming up on Joe, hello, I am the DCM for district ten. And I am going to give the GSR report for the Air Force group. We do not have a GSR currently. All the other positions are filled except for steering committee rep, which really doesn't pertain to our business. But we're doing pretty steady, fifteen to twenty, wouldn't you say, Dennis? Yes. And, you know that's better than a year ago when it was twelve to fifteen, you know and um.

Speaker 5

Things are going well. We're not meeting tonight. I guess that's old news now, but it's Thursday. But that's all I have for the airport group report. Thank you,

Speaker 4

Paul. My name is Paul. I am an alcoholic and an interested party. I am the H and I coordinator for District Eleven, and unfortunately, it seems like a useless position given, We don't have any facilities, but you guys have facilities. I understand we

don't have any Alquippa. No, they're not there. Okay, do you guys? But I also we had two, We only have one now, and they said, they don't really want my meetings coming in. Don't ask me why? Because you know, we were always ready to step up. So am.

Speaker 4

So, I am trying to figure out what to do with myself. With that, So what I have decided to do is get involved at the area sixty level. So, I am going to make a real quick pitch here if it's okay, right? Sure. So, Bridge Gap is : I am working with Area Sixty, Maurice and Mariah to build a database of different treatment facilities in the different districts and a database of. Prisons and other institutions in the different districts in the Western PA, you know, Area 60's Western PA. And my objective is to build this database so that people coming out of a prison will have some contact, a database of somebody in their district, their home district that they're going to go to, To help bridge the gap between the prison facility and going to a few meetings outside the prison. So that they get their feet wet in AA.

Speaker 4

So, it's really it does sound like you're just bridging the gap of that period until they get themselves established outside. And, we also are working in the same vein to build the database where we find people who are willing to go into treatment facilities and take meetings, and that kind of stuff into those different treatment facilities. So, because I don't really have any direct work In my district, I've decided to start working more closely with the area level just to keep myself involved with service. And that kind of thing. But if you don't mind, also I did bring. I don't know if you guys got to attend Woodstock, it's still City Woodstock. It was a great time. But I have if you can take back to your districts uh, to your uh, different your respective home groups. This information here, if you want, pass it around.

Speaker 4

And and it talks about the bridge gap program, and it talks about uh about uh it has my contact information, My email at the bottom where if somebody wants to sign up for any of these type of initiatives, they're welcome to do so. And and uh um you know, hopefully, you know, hope it's going to be more difficult if you don't have any H and I facilities here, you don't have any institutions here. But that doesn't mean people aren't willing to cross over a different into a different district. So, I am really just looking for interested parties at this point. And I am about to send out an email confirming who's interested and who's not. But I will certainly add anybody to the database. But, my true reason to come was to hear some of these items that you guys are going to go over tonight with the agenda items for PCOAL because I don't know that I am going to get that before the PCOAL with my own group, my own district. So, I appreciate your time.

Speaker 4

If you guys want to take any of these, I also have those just little pieces of paper.

You can hand out that has my email address on it. Thank you.

Speaker 2

Thank you, Paul. Thanks for being here. Yep,

Speaker 1

Thanks for your service. Right, I did not get any emails from any of the non-reporting groups, so we are flying blind on a couple of them, But uh I am going to assume no news is good news in that regard. Do we have a treasurer's report?

Speaker 6

Um sure.

Speaker 6

Let's see. Well, Tonight, I got uh forty dollars from the Monday Corey closed discussion and I got twenty five dollars from Clinton. It's all about me Monday night. So that's sixty five dollars plus seven ninety three. So stay tuned, if you need a new total because I don't know what it is.

Speaker 1

Um, There's some math involved, right?

Speaker 6

There's some math involved. But, so we did have seven hundred and ninety three dollars and fifty three cents, and we're waiting to go in a bank. So if we have that bank account set up, I wasn't sure yet, so I brought the envelope. Otherwise, I'll just take it home and wait. Awesome thing. And I don't know if anybody else has any contributions to make put it in my book at this time or.

Speaker 6

Thank you. See you next month. Thanks.

Speaker 1

All right, speaking of the bank account number, the IRS has not gotten back to me on approval for a nonprofit. We do have a valid EIN number; it's just not a nonprofit yet. And I would personally prefer waiting for the nonprofit status, so we don't have to play the rigmarole with the tax man at the end of the year.

Speaker 1

As soon as the IRS gets back to me, I am more than happy to provide all that paperwork. I just know, starting a nonprofit at the beginning of tax season is probably not our smartest move in the district, but worse mistakes have happened. Um, what else we have in the way of old business? The website is up and running. I don't know if everybody got an opportunity to take a look at that. Um, There is some more work for me to do on that. I don't have an ingestion pipeline for events yet, but that is in the works. As always, I am open to any suggestions or like points

of view. Do we have any other old business? I think that covers all of it that I have notes on. Oh.

Speaker 1

Yeah, absolutely. Non- profit. Correct.

Speaker 1

Yeah, Um, honestly the way I did it, uh all the paperwork's been filed and already sent off to the IRS. Soum. No, no, you are all good. I did not really have any input in that. Um, I hit up my business attorney and was like," This is what we're looking to do," and he said," Here we go. I'll file the paperwork; it'll be done." So that's pretty good. Great job.

Speaker 4

If, you don't mind this really fascinates me. Um What is the value of getting this status? Is it just for the banking purposes or.

Speaker 1

That And a little bit more. So it gives us an official EIN, so we're a recognized entity by the federal government and the state. So, it does give us the immediate benefit of being able to put money in a bank account that is actually District Ten's.

Speaker 4

And not that person's name, correct? And.

Speaker 1

Then also what it does is it lets everybody at this table be on the board. So there's like a formalized vote structure, And that gives us a level of liability in case something happens at our uh like gratitude event. God forbid something happens, district ten is its own entity.

Speaker 4

Not the person who has the bank account.

Speaker 1

Exactly, And nobody can be going after me or god forbid, whoever, because we held an event and somebody slipped down the stairs.

Speaker 4

That's a great. So, you know,

Speaker 2

Purchase purchase you have purchase value with it too.

Speaker 4

Yeah, does that mean you have to come up with bylaws then too doesn't it? Correct. And, that means also then you have to do some processes when you take

somebody off of the bylaws. And as a member and on right It's going to complicate you guys when it comes to some of those things. No,

Speaker 1

All you need to remove or add somebody to the leadership group is uh quorum. And as long as a quorum passes a vote at an official board meeting, it's said and done.

Speaker 4

And will all these people who are on the board, will they be able to sign on the account or just we'll have.

Speaker 1

So the signatory for the bank account is our secretary. So it'll only be the secretary. Correct.

Speaker 4

Interesting. Okay. Do you won't have two counter signatures? Another counter signature?

Speaker 1

We could, but we have not established that at this time.

Speaker 4

I would suggest that.

Speaker 6

Is not the treasurer?

Speaker 1

Oh, I'm sorry. Yeah, the treasurer. Did I say secretary? I'm sorry. No, I want nothing to do with the money. I am not the money guy at all. All right, appreciate you entertaining my question. No, absolutely. I'm open book Any questions you have, I'm happy to answer Um And then I am seeing under new business.

Speaker 1

No, we're good. Okay, I'm sorry. Lights on. Um, all business. All right, does anybody have any new business to bring to the table?

Speaker 5

Um, well the new business will be the twenty- one agenda items, right? Yep. Um, did you want the BCM report first? Absolutely. Okay. All right, Joe needs nowum, Just have a short and sweet DCM report. I um, since our last meeting, I did register for PCOCA, so I will be going. I'll give you that receipt after I attend. So, I don't want to give it to you and like get the money and then don't go. You know? So uh after my report on PCOCA, I will give i will give you the receipt. Um And. Uh. I attended the Wednesday meeting at St Andrews um And.

Speaker 5

I also attended. It was just yesterday or two days ago, Tuesday. Who meets on Tuesday in the district? We.

Speaker 3

Do for our recovery in real life.

Speaker 1

Recovery in real life, Dallas, Along with the Deaf and Hard of Hearing community—like.

Speaker 5

You can't remember where you were.

Speaker 3

Oh, St.

Speaker 7

Mary's— I believe. New beginnings,

Speaker 5

Yeah. That's where I was. Yeah, And let them know we were here and The St Andrews meeting seems like a pretty lively place. And they're pretty involved in other stuff, you know, service work. So maybe they'll get a GSR and join us. But it's a Wednesday meeting at St Andrews, yeah. And it's Tuesday was uh.

Speaker 3

Beginnings. Yeah, I stopped going because they were having me do. I was a GSR on Tuesday, and then they were making me do it for Wednesday, and I was like.

Speaker 5

No beginning, St Margaret's it was St Margaret Donaghue Education Center. Yeah,

Speaker 6

I was at the Monday night meeting and I think they were having a group conscience after for a GSR vote. So that Monday night meeting that you went to, yeah,

Speaker 5

In this.

Speaker 6

Church downstairs. Yeah, so maybe they'll know.

Speaker 5

All right, well that'd be good. I am pretty happy with how we're getting along here actually. You know, I was a little worried when Holly left and and who was our Ron left? We had some pretty big shoes to fill. Yeah, we did. It's going pretty good, so

thanks for that. Um, and I guess the new business is I printed out the twenty- one agenda items, but I um you guys all up for a little discussion on that? Sure. Absolutely. Great. I'm gonna read the uh.

Speaker 6

Yes. Do you want another coffee? We can share if you don't get it.

Speaker 5

Yeah, I'll have my phone. I'll have them on my phone because I'm gonna read the email Thank, you You have it too. Joe? Yeah, I got it on my phone right here.

Speaker 5

So, the email that was sent out from Area sixty says, "Hello, Area sixty AA Fellowship. We have finalized the agenda items that will be discussed at this year's Peacock." Originally, They were saying like eight items would be discussed ;. They were going to pick eight. Well, it says attached you will find the twenty-one items and their background materials. I didn't print out the background materials but um.

Speaker 7

Was that the hundred and twenty four page thing that was attached to it? Yeah, you did get the email.

Speaker 2

Good lady, all right. Your machine was going goofy. I'll look better next time.

Speaker 5

It says if you have not done so already, Please begin meeting with your home group or district to gather your group conscience, so you will be ready to bring it to discussions and voting sessions at Peacock. I don't know how they operate at peak hour anymore. It used to be when you when you walked in there, They had you could pick which um agenda item you wanted to to be a part of a of a um committee about, You know what I mean? But it sounds like the way they're wording this, they'll have um everybody discussing and voting on each agenda item instead of just. Oh my gosh, that's going to be pandemonium. Yeah. That's going to be chaos. Yeah. Um.

Speaker 5

Maybe maybe they still run it that way where you can just pick one. You know what I mean? That uh I haven't been to one in like since pre-COVID so, um, It says we give the collective conscience of Area sixty to our delegates to take to the conference in New York City. So um, One thing I want to uh add about that is I've been like trying to explain to people what we do here. You know what I mean? And reading this sentence made me realize that What we do is, if our home group cares enough, we get their voice heard at the national level. You know what I mean? But most groups like, "Yeah, whatever you think." You know what I mean? And they don't want to give

any input. And that's the way my group is. But we're here to offer that opportunity. You know, that's.

Speaker 5

So that made me feel like, okay, that's my purpose now. You know what I mean? I know my purpose is to give people an opportunity to be heard, as far as AA business goes at the national level. So it says, "All are welcome and encouraged to attend P-Call." Your voice can't be heard if you don't participate in P-Call. Is one of the best ways to participate in the service part of the A - H - I triangle. And and um. The service manual tells us the GSR can be the voice of their home group, you know, even if they don't have any input. You know what I mean? They obviously they're the voting member of the home group. So, if you want to go to P call and get your two cents in for what you think would be your home group's conscience, then that's that's the way to do it, you know.

Speaker 5

And it says," attached to you will find a peak car registration," which I used and I filled that out. And I am registered to go. So, did you want to go, Jane?

Speaker 3

No, and I just don't know how to sign up for it. Be very honest; I am not good at that kind of stuff. But yes, I will go if you want me to go.

Speaker 5

What is the registration? It is one hundred dollars or something hundred and fucking a half Is. It really? Yeah.

Speaker 4

Hundred and fifty dollars. Yeah,

Speaker 5

They give you dinner twice, I think.

Speaker 4

Oh, That's for, but for me to attend if I don't. If I want to just commute back and forth is there's this enormous fee? Isn't there?

Speaker 2

Sunday's the only day it's free Paul. Yeah. The rest of the day it's included with that hundred and fifty dollar ticket. And dinners are extra They need to make five thousand bucks committed to that hotel for dinners It's. A it's an automatic.

Speaker 7

Is that the? Is it the whole streaming room? Yes, yes, yes.

Speaker 2

Oh, with a pop bill. Can.

Speaker 3

I still register if I don't go there? Like can I go there and register? Yes. Okay,

Speaker 1

You can register on site. Yeah.

Speaker 3

Okay, If I am not there.

Speaker 5

And if you are here and you want to go, I'll take you. Awesome thing with yeah. Okayum so do we want to read these line by line these agenda items and see if anybody has any input on each one? I think we can get through them pretty quick because a lot of them, we're not going to have any, I think, any strong feelings about, you know. Um. Let's see here. Here.

Speaker 6

We go. Should we go around the room and we can each read one? Thank you. All right, okay.

Speaker 5

I'll startum. New draft of the fifth edition of the Big Book of Alcoholics Anonymous. So obviously that doesn't, we don't we can't have any input on that here, you know what I mean? Because we don't know what the draft looks like.

Speaker 2

It's been in the process for over a year and a half now. Yeah. Every twenty years, they bring out a new Big Book, and this is going to be the fifth fifth edition. Right And it's an up and down thing right now, it's not signed in stone. Yeah,

Speaker 5

It takes forever to do anything in AA so soum, I'll report back to you guys on all these all this stuff next month. Um, Obviously, we don't have a draft of the fifth edition of the of the Alcoholics Anonymous to look at, so let's move on to number two.

Speaker 4

The second one is consider a request to define eligibility for area level service for members residing outside of the geographic area they want to serve. To me that's really not a big issue. I don't know that it would require whole lot.

Speaker 5

Discussion. I guess they're saying, like, if somebody lives on.

Speaker 1

I don't see that being an issue because I mean, I live in a completely different

district, but I attend meetings and am a member of District Ten. I don't see a need for formalization saying I'm allowed to do that.

Speaker 5

Right, right.

Speaker 2

Exactly. Area level. So if I live in Wirt and West Virginia, I have the ability and. And I can request that the come to serve as a right. Yes, that's what it is. You are outside of area sixty. Yes, area sixty is huge. Oh, it's massive! Yeah, Pennsylvania Erie over to Altoona down the, and that's it. And t here is.

Speaker 5

So do you are you guys saying that we should say it's okay to somebody outside of the area to serve? If somebody wants to serve,

Speaker 7

They should be allowed to serve.

Speaker 2

Yes, exactly.

Speaker 2

Yes, yes. You know,

Speaker 4

Especially if there's nobody available to do the exactly.

Speaker 1

Yes. I'm never telling AA where I live.

Speaker 1

If you want to be a member and help this, like by all means, please help. We need it so I'll vote yes on that. Yes. Okay, number three? Uh, Consider a request to produce an animated video based on the pamphlet "T. He Twelve Steps Illustrated."

Speaker 3

I think that'd be cool for people who can't read. You know, There are people like in the program, probably that aren't like don't read very well or something they could show in prison or something, you know, if they don't have the.

Speaker 2

That's actually an awesomeum idea if it's Mickey Mouse though. I got the Twelve Traditions Illustrated here. That's pretty cool pamphlet to have you know.

Speaker 1

Yeah, I've been preaching since I got involved in it all. The more accessibility and

availability we have, the better we are across the board. If we can give somebody a tool and it helps a single person, it was worth every penny spent on it. That's just my personal two cents on that.

Speaker 6

So that's a yes. Are we getting agreement on that?

Speaker 7

That's a yes. Good, all right.

Speaker 3

Consider requests to produce in LA wait, I read that one. Sorry, no, no, no. That's for another one. Okay, Consider a request to produce an anime video based on a pamphlet of the twelve traditions illustrated well for yes, and the steps you got.

Speaker 7

My thanks. Juicyhuh? Okay consider consider a request to review locally produced, Sa fety- related video service material and provide input on the potential for this video service material to be adapted to use by GSO. Okay, just explain that.

Speaker 1

Somebody put together a safety manual. I remember seeing this about a year ago being passed around.

Speaker 6

It's a yellow. Oh yes, I remember that.

Speaker 1

Yeah, it's for uh like the safety of a meeting, What to do just in case X, Y, Z happens. If there is a fire, if there is an active shooter incident. It seemed like valuable information when I saw it. That said, I haven't seen it in over a year. So I have no idea what's on it currently.

Speaker 4

You know from my own experience, our home group did need that recently for something that came up during our home group. So the literature was really valuable. And so the question is, Do you feel like that should be translated into a video that people might be more interested in watching a video as opposed to reading literature?

Speaker 3

I'd say yes. Cause they know. Yeah.

Speaker 5

Again, The only place anybody's going to see these videos are like workshops and stuff anyway, but if it's out there and what that's good, right?

Speaker 4

I mean, The only thing I would say that's a pretty to produce. A video is is a great deal of expense when there's something already in literature. You know, that would be my only comment I would have on that. Yeah.

Speaker 7

So within reason? Financial within financial reason, yeah.

Speaker 5

Are the funds available?

Speaker 1

And what is that? What is the official memo on like what are our official safety rules? Because I am all for putting them out there, but if there is something in there that's complete nonsense, let's nix that one and make sure we're getting good information out there.

Speaker 4

So, are you saying that it should be based upon the existing literature that's available? Is that kind of what you're saying?

Speaker 1

Yeah, I mean, Plus a church that's four stories tall and has a meeting on the fourth story is going to have some different safety concerns than a meeting in the basement of a church or in an open field at a park. So, we need to take that into make sure that they're open ended enough that they can be translated across different groups. Instead of we all meet in basements of churches.

Speaker 5

I was thinking more along the lines of like sexual harassment or intimidation, you know what I mean? Those are hard and fast.

Speaker 3

There it is right there. So,

Speaker 2

That Is in the pamphlet. Yeah, so like Paul said that making this video might not be in the budget.

Speaker 5

Yeah, I'll ask about the funds and after a reasonable discussion, if I think it's reasonable with us.

Speaker 5

Go ahead. Knock your socks off, so much. All right, number six. This is where it gets juicy. Consider a.

Speaker 8

Request to remove a quote from Doctor Bob from the PA service guide manual.
What was the quote?

Speaker 5

Well, the background material is in this. Let me see if I can find the background material.

Speaker 8

I just want to say first off, I wouldn't want to take anything out of what Doctor Bob said.

Speaker 6

Yeah, me neither. Yeah. It's helping me to know. It's a no, no matter what. I don't care if he said something about my mom.

Speaker 2

He's got some manner. Definitely a.

Speaker 7

Big yes on that one.

Speaker 1

And you found it?

Speaker 7

Is that in that hundred and twenty four page thing?

Speaker 2

Yeah, I'm trying to find it right there. Is that in the back of the book? It's in there. I'm gonna say no, I don't care what the logo was on it. I agree with Jim here today,

Speaker 3

Yeah, yeah, yeah, yeah, okay, It's already been around for how many years? Oh, my goodness. What are you going to do, take a bunch of big books and rip that page out or something? Everybody. Well,

Speaker 2

This is good. Yeah, Like I just said now that that's part of the publication of the fifth edition. Now they can take some of that wording out. Oh, I see what you're saying. You understand? No, This is a quote from.

Speaker 6

Doctor Ayesha Service Man Yes Yes Yes But I'm going to say no. Keep Bob in the service manual. Yeah,

Speaker 8

I'm still upset when they took out, you know, if you've reached this step and and you you can throw the book away, you know, you've now reached step three. Right at the end of the steps. It used to say You have now reached step three. You know, if you don't have an understanding, you should either reread the book to this point or throw it away. And they took that out.

Speaker 6

Was that in third? No, that was in the second edition. Second, oh okay. I can't get my hands on one of those. I have the third.

Speaker 5

Okay, sounds like you guys are saying no to that one.

Speaker 6

No, yeah. All right,

Speaker 5

I've got to look that up. I got to see what this whole. Yeah, Yeah. I'll send you the email; it has all the background material. Yeah,

Speaker 4

I think I had that, but send it to me anyway, if you don't mind. Okay, here's my email address right here Joe.

Speaker 6

Okay, next.

Speaker 9

Consider publishing the personal stories from the fourth edition of Alcoholics Anonymous not included in the draft fifth edition of Alcoholics Anonymous. I love those personal stories. Didn't they do that with the third edition? Aren't those stories somewhere on the internet? I've seen them before. Well,

Speaker 2

They did it with a new plain language too. There's no stories; just the first hundred sixty four pages.

Speaker 5

Look, can I tell you what the background information was on Doctor Balka? Sure, please This information is for committee eyes only.

Speaker 5

So, I guess they'll tell us the information at PECO. I would assume so. So, if you're on that committee, you know what I mean, if you choose to be on that committee at PECO, then they'll probably tell you what they're trying to remove. So, but I will go with our group conscience here and say don't follow it.

Speaker 6

All right. We don't care if it's even about Jim's mother.

Speaker 8

What's it going to say? Doctor Bob was a drunk?

Speaker 5

Okay. All right, so where are we at?

Speaker 10

Um, consider publishing first personal stories.

Speaker 6

I mean, it's in the fourth edition, so.

Speaker 8

It's available online.

Speaker 5

So you think we should keep them available? But, they're asking if they want to make them print them in the fifth edition, right? Yeah. Okay, so we'll go with new stories in the fifth edition. Is that what you're saying?

Speaker 8

Well, You don't have to print a separate book of just the stories that aren't going to be included.

Speaker 6

They just do it online. I already did it, yeah.

Speaker 8

Yeah, they'll just push a couple PDFs to the website.

Speaker 5

I gotcha. Okay. All right. Okay, I'm hearing no on that one. Okay. All rightMoving on?

Speaker 10

Yep Consider a request that standalone audio visual clips be created, When developing any new and revised videos for professionals. Where would they stand?

Speaker 6

I don't know.

Speaker 1

I don't have enough information to have an informed opinion on that.

Speaker 6

Yeah, I've never seen a video for a professional so. Big question mark. Yeah,

Speaker 8

Big question mark.

Speaker 5

Okay, I'll listen to their spiel, and you guys trust me to vote our conscience on that one. Like you've got a good pulse on the group, I'll trust you on that one. Okay.

Speaker 6

Next one? Is that me? Yes. Consider a request to update the pamphlet, The AA Member: Medications and Other Drugs. There are some corrections on 3 C.

Speaker 4

I mean, seems to be like if there are corrections that need to be made, especially when it comes to drugs and stuff like that, maybe it makes sense to move forward with that.

Speaker 6

Yeah. Yeah.

Speaker 8

Is that kind of like you could. I'm sorry. My opinion was that the Big Book was pretty clear on it. If you're under a doctor's care and taking medications as prescribed. Yeah. Right? That's it.

Speaker 4

Yeah. You're down- to- earth on this stuff You're like the Big Book is. That's it, man It's the Bible.

Speaker 1

Our literature says seeking outside help is. A valid option, right? So.

Speaker 8

You shouldn't have to change your sobriety date because you're taking something that, right, you shouldn't be on.

Speaker 5

If the correction they want to make though is just like a like a. Yeah, it would depend on the correction. Update something. Probably going to have to trust.

Speaker 4

You on that one too. Drug is no longer available, or they found the drug is hazardous to us or something like that. Right,

Speaker 8

I mean it's back in the day they took more risk. We don't do that anymore, right?

Speaker 1

As long as it aligns with our literature and I mean because I don't see an issue with updating and correcting information as long as we're aligned with the message of AACE still. Right, as long as it's not changing the message.

Speaker 3

And I don't know if they think. There are some people who have a drug addiction that the only meeting they get to is AA.

Speaker 1

Yeah, I mean, personally, I qualify for about every fellowship out there. So that's why I say. But this is the one that's staying home to me. So I'm an alcoholic.

Speaker 3

Even though you're not supposed to. That's why I say I'm an alcoholic addict. So there's somebody in the room can't, you know. But let's do that. Don't tell my sponsor.

Speaker 5

The only requirement for membership is a desire to stop drinking? Exactly, yeah. If you are not an alcoholic, though, you are not that's you are not. You don't have the qualifications of being Alcoholics Anonymous, right? All right. So I am going to get through it. We'll give a discretion room. All right which Which number we on next?

Speaker 2

Consider the question to create a twelve step study guide or workbook. I say no because you can get all that online; it's already available. I have a new sponsee and I just got everything today for him Well,

Speaker 4

I mean. The flip side of that is you get these from different sources, and you know what I am saying. And are any of them sanctioned? I don't really know. T here is a Joe and Charlie's guide for example. That's the one I use with my sponsor,

Speaker 9

Right? And it was horrible with grammar the spelling. Yeah, I mean the idea was good but like it was awful.

Speaker 4

You know so I think t here is probably, and even when it comes to doing your fourth step, there are several different formats on what different five columns, four columns three. There's also one right in the big book. Oh,

Speaker 8

I just read through the book. You can see why there is a" big book." You're right, Jim. You get a hold of Hazelton's Guide to Suicide. You know, I want you to.

Speaker 2

Plus the sponsor can relate personal things because you can't be a sponsor unless you've been there, done that. And, that's what the Twelve and Twelve actually does something for that aspect of it. Yes, Paul. Like your 12 steps, study yes, your sponsor yes.

Speaker 1

Between the Big Book, your sponsor and the 12 and 12 you already have your guiding workbooks. Exactly.

Speaker 4

So we're not changing anything. No no no no no Can I make a comment? When, we go back and look at some of these things. I can see how GSO sometimes has financial troubles because they just want to make make make things and that all costs money, you know Yeah It's interesting So, we're going to save them some money and say, "No, we don't need that." All right. I bet you any money that one passes, though. People are going to want it.

Speaker 2

Okay. You're up, Joe.

Speaker 5

Consider a request to discuss the location of the general service conference. I guess they want to change it around. I'm not even sure where it is now,

Speaker 2

But. I just got an email the other day that remodeling of the asbestos is complete, and it's in New York City. Manhattan. So it sounds like they want to change where they meet. I guess downtown Manhattan, you know, it's pretty pricey, but they just redid the floor. I mean,

Speaker 5

I think I think we could probably trust the people in New York that are in charge of that kind of stuff. There's like all yeah, okay. All right.

Speaker 7

Like what's the answer on that one?

Speaker 5

We're going to say do whatever you want.

Speaker 7

That's What you're sitting in your city.

Speaker 1

You know what to do, okay? Yeah, I.

Speaker 5

Guess. Yeah, this is up to you. They can't just change it without asking us, I guess. Yeah, Probably pretty cool how AA works really like little people get to have a say and everything again. But Okay,

Speaker 4

The next one consider that the A Grapevine Inc accept contributions. I think this one has to do with upping the contribution level Joe Is that right?

Speaker 5

No, I think AA exists only on their sale of their literature, the Big Book. They're self-supporting and they're saying, "Can we have people donate directly to the Grapevine?" It used to be like they set it up that it had to support itself. You know what I mean? So now they're saying. Do we think it's okay for them to accept contributions? They're not a separate entity, really. Yes,

Speaker 2

But what it is set up now they don't take donations, but there's a waiting list for people to get subscriptions. Most of them are in jails institutions. But, if somebody in the body of AA home group, whatever has it in their budget, all they got to do is contact Grapevine dot org. And say, "Hey, I want to donate to the waiting list, so that person next in line gets a subscription." That's how it is now. They're saying no; they want the direct donation. Yeah,

Speaker 4

Well, and you know,

Speaker 6

I never heard of that.

Speaker 4

They updated the direct donation number from what four thousand to ten thousand or and they're doing really good.

Speaker 2

Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 4

And I think that this is along that same line. To be perfectly honest with you, sometimes I feel there is pieces of AA that are more valuable. And, the grapevine might be one of them that I might be willing to donate some sum of money for the grapevine. So it would get to prisons and that kind of stuff, As opposed to maybe having them do a video on the on the, you know on safety group safety.

Speaker 6

Agree, I agree.

Speaker 4

So I like my I like the idea that I can target my money where I think it's most valuable.

Speaker 1

One point of view on this, I have a lot of friends that are just like me in early recovery. Sadly, A bunch of them are not employed, and they feel bad coming to a meeting and not being able to put a dollar in the basket. Should, we add another quote handout asking for a dollar when there is already people in these rooms that feel bad, not being able to give one? No.

Speaker 6

No, that's not what they mean. No, no,

Speaker 2

No, no. That's what I am saying is how are we going to publicize this? That's my concern.

Speaker 5

We're gonna have to ask the grapevine rep to say, by the way, if you want to send a donation to the grapevine, it'd be up to the grapevine.

Speaker 7

They're now in some way, like it doesn't have to be from the group either. Like if you know,

Speaker 2

If I decide I am.

Speaker 7

Going can send them twenty bucks like,

Speaker 2

And that gentleman that may be unemployed. He. He can get himself on the waiting list. All he got to do is contact grapevine dot org. Hey, I am so and so, I'd like to be on that waiting list. And then when the opportunity comes, they just keep moving the people up and they'll get a year subscription.

Speaker 1

Yeah, I just know a lot of my friends are like I've got guys that are upset that they can't put a dollar in the basket when I bring them to meetings. And I am worried about another donation being added. That might off put new people or lower income people.

Speaker 2

That is my concern. I don't want that donation put in there because we don't need another meeting. We need the publication and the grapevine is financially doing

well. People are misled thinking that they're they're hurt, but they're they're financially doing good.

Speaker 4

That's not what they said at the world service conference. That's not what they said at the world service conference.

Speaker 2

Alan just brought it out at the last meeting. You must have had cotton in your ears. No,

Speaker 6

Yeah, I always assumed they weren't doing that good either. I was under the assumption they weren't doing that good. Yeah,

Speaker 2

I know they made a special plea saying that. Yes, they had a plea, But it's just like the area and the district donated Carnegie. And then at the end of the year, they get out of the black or into the red. The grapevine is the same and, Problem with the grapevine, all their material that they get most of the papers coming out of Canada. I.

Speaker 6

Have a question: Can we at the meetings ask the grapevine? Uh, reps to let people know that they can donate this list. Like I didn't know I did.

Speaker 2

Every meeting I go to, every meeting I go to, and they say," Is there any AA announcements?" You stand up say," I am so and so," and yeah, I'd like to share that. Plus if there is anybody that has extra grape pies please bring them. The Grenadi office has stacks of them; they take them to the prisons. Yep those guys and ladies.

Speaker 8

In prison are Yes.

Speaker 5

So, what do we think about this? Are we going to let them accept donations or not? Yes. Yes. Jim says yes. Yes.

Speaker 5

All right, so that's three yes from our from our practitioner.

Speaker 1

I say, yes, depending on how they publicize it. I'm I'm concerned with how they're publicly going to say we're accepting donations, but aside from that,

Speaker 6

I'm in when I was new my sponsor was like, You know, if you don't have a dollar, take one out. Doesn't matter.

Speaker 2

I've done that honestly. I was unemployable and that came with the unmanageable. And guess what? God knows I am taking that money for a bus to go to another meeting. It ain't like I am going to buy some booze or drugs. That's an honor system and that's how you are going to stay sober. And guess what? When I got on my feet, that money was returned.

Speaker 5

We have more yeses, so that's a majority. So I'm gonna go with yes on that. You can say that. All right, okay, who's up next?

Speaker 1

Review the five- year plans for. excuse me. review the five- year plans for both Grapevine and Lavina.

Speaker 5

That's not really a voteable thing;.

Speaker 1

They're just going to tell us what their plan is. Let's hear your plan, yes.

Speaker 5

I Would like to review it. And, like I said before,

Speaker 2

I'll report back to you guys on all this. You going to speak in Spanish or in English?

Speaker 5

I did take three years of Spanish in high school. Well then that's good. You can give a little bit of it.

Speaker 2

It was a long time ago. You know how to say salt and pepper?

Speaker 3

Discuss motion to add wording into F 3 with this one that ends one Oh, discuss the general service Oh, sorry Consider the A's grapevine, Accept contributions. Which one?

Speaker 7

No, right there. Discuss the general service. Oh,

Speaker 3

Thank you. It's because I asked them to write their assignments, but discuss the general service conference final report. Well,

Speaker 9

They're going to do it.

Speaker 5

Yeah, they're going to do it. Yeah, they're just talking about discussing it right now. Let's see; I got to make sure I am on the right number here.

Speaker 7

Next. I think so. Discuss motion to add wording to item F three, self support where money and spirituality mix. I don't know enough about that.

Speaker 10

That's in the backup. That's vague too though. Um Do you have the backup on that?

Speaker 3

No, Because I think that has something kind of like what he had to say, you know if you depend on how you word it, So people don't feel guilty. You know, I've heard this thing. Yeah, it was in there. You know,

Speaker 1

I'm not familiar with that self support. I'm assuming literature self Supporting, Their own contributions or money.

Speaker 5

It's a pamphlet out It's a pamphlet You know what I mean. And uhuh.

Speaker 10

But, this doesn't give enough detail Yeah exactly What. Are they wanting to add? Why? Is this even here Or where money and spirituality met in the back up?

Speaker 4

I'll Second that.

Speaker 6

They need to provide a search function. One thing I'm going to see, yeah.

Speaker 1

What type of file is it? PDF,

Speaker 4

Although I think I had the option perhaps open in Word.

Speaker 5

I forwarded this email to you guys if you want to if you guys, Before the peacock

comes up, if you guys want to, um.

Speaker 4

Yeah, if there's something that really interests you, you can always get back to Joe on it. Oh yeah. It's given me some ideas on what I want to focus my attention on now.

Speaker 5

Yeah. Like you said, there's a hundred and twenty- some pages of this, so I'm having trouble.

Speaker 1

Got highlighters in my work truck. We can get down on this one hundred and twenty seven pages.

Speaker 8

Okay, next. Let's see, sixteen. Discuss workshop topics ideas for two thousand seven general service council. I am going to say how about something like uh sarcasm and sobriety? Seriously? No oh.

Speaker 5

I'm just going to listen to what they have to say and get it off my head on that one, all right? Just.

Speaker 6

Uh, I like the one spreading the message like into jails and institutions. Okay.

Speaker 5

Yeah, that's a good workshop idea. Okay i'll I'll put my two cents in on that.

Speaker 5

Let me make sure I'm on the right number here. Discuss.

Speaker 9

Ways to encourage interest and participation at regional forums. Give.

Speaker 6

Out candy.

Speaker 5

Encourage interest and participation at regional forums. Okay, um, I don't think they're asking us to do that. I think they're saying that's what they're going to do at the conference. So, um, once again, if you guys can think of anything on on these discussion uh agendas, Give me a call or an email, and you know, give me some good ideas if you if you got some good ideas for that.

Speaker 6

Interesting meeting.

Speaker 1

I feel like I'm going to beat a dead horse on this, but getting younger people involved, that is the lifeblood that's going to carry through. We need to get more people my age and under involved in AA. If we want to continue this thing moving forward.

Speaker 2

Okay, I agree with you on that. Thank you.

Speaker 1

We need to get more youth in these rooms.

Speaker 8

All right, it's been my experience if they're new in AA, You don't ask him to do it. You kind of like volunteer.

Speaker 1

Oh, I was volunteering. Yeah, yeah.

Speaker 8

That's the old timers did to me.

Speaker 1

Yeah, Miss Jamie stared me down and I was like, yep, okay, cool. I am our GSR right?

Speaker 4

Can I ask what's your sobriety date? Sorry? If you don't mind asking what's your sobriety date?

Speaker 8

July eleventh nineteen ninety six Wow That's what we need in this room That's good It's just a number. No, I understand. Today is the day. Today is the important. Okay.

Speaker 5

All right, who's up next?

Speaker 10

Me? Okay. Scott's offering ten minutes of presentation time during the general service conference to Lavigne.

Speaker 10

Ten minutes of presentation. That's probably something.

Speaker 5

We're going to be in. That's ten more minutes. Yeah, yeah, okay, we'll go ahead. Is

Lavigne the same as Lavigne? Like because it's not.

Speaker 1

Yeah, I don't think they are; they're spelled very differently. Maybe that's the French; it is the French for. Yep, okay.

Speaker 6

Review progress report from subcommittee on inclusion of. Sovereign state flags in the IC flag ceremony.

Speaker 5

That's the international convention. They have a flag ceremony before the meeting or before. So what's the question?

Speaker 9

Just review, progress report.

Speaker 5

Oh okay,

Speaker 1

Sure. If we have a meeting in that country, their flag should be there, hard stop. I mean, yeah,

Speaker 5

Yeah, agreed.

Speaker 1

We don't want to get involved in the politics exactly like if there is a meeting there. Cool.

Speaker 5

Yeah, that's right. Yep, it doesn't sound like that's a voting item either. They're just going to tell us what their progress report is. Yeah,

Speaker 2

Okay, all right. Discusses suggestions to discontinue the annual review of service kits and workbooks by conference committees and T. Here is one similar that is no longer mailed out. And that was uh. The CPI, PI work, and you have to download it off the computer. And that young lady right there, there's a hundred and some pages, whatever. And you want to make your own publication. When I became GSR years ago, they did mail me a kit. I believe they don't even do that anymore.

Speaker 1

No, I got a link to a PDF set when I got registered. That's what I'm saying.

Speaker 2

So the money's not there. So, I don't think are going to approve it.

Speaker 5

It sounds to me like what they're trying to say is, "We're always looking for something. What can we change?" They're saying, "Let's not do that anymore." Yes, let's discontinue the annual review of all the service kits and workbooks. You know what I mean? Like, we don't have to review this stuff every year;. It seems to be working. You know what I mean? Right, right. All right, all right. And that sounds like a discussion; there's not going to be any. Anytime you see a discuss, there's not going to be a vote on it anyway. If it says consider a request, there's going to be a vote on it. You know what I mean? There's no option there. All right.

Speaker 4

Last one, what did we do that review the world service social media policy? No,

Speaker 5

That's the last one reviewed that. Uh, a a world service social media policy. So they're just gonna they're just gonna review it. Yeah, tell us what it is, I guess like whether there should be changes or they'll come back with the social? And once again, I will have all this information for you guys uh at the next monthly meeting.

Speaker 6

You say it was the seventeenth?

Speaker 2

Yeah, Seventeenth through nineteenth, I think Friday Saturday and Sunday seventeen eighteen nineteen.

Speaker 4

Can I ask a question? Do you guys rotate the, Chair of the between GSRs, is that how that happens?

Speaker 1

No, secretary runs it. Is what was happening before I was secretary, and I just kind of tried to fill Holly's shoes the best I could.

Speaker 4

Yeah, usually our DCM runs it, Which I actually think it's really nice because it prepares the secretary for the next position. Yeah.

Speaker 2

I think that Pecan, no, there's no discussion. Secretary and third regarding the website.

Speaker 1

Costs were completely absorbed by personal donation.

Speaker 2

I was on the committee and I stepped down because I've been in this committee for three years now. And it's the same thing.

Speaker 1

Yeah, So all of the website costs were a hundred percent absorbed by people personally donating to getting our district website up and running. We have three years' worth of funds already donated into that.

Speaker 1

On year four, when we yeah when we would need to renew that internet license, It is currently going to be eleven dollars a year to keep our website up and operational.

Speaker 4

Do you get the website? You got the domain name and everything. He's a.

Speaker 5

Master of that stuff.

Speaker 4

And, you're doing this for eleven dollars because from the nonprofit that I'm a member of. They charge just like a hundred dollars or something.

Speaker 1

So I own my own server rack and I'm a software developer. So I built everything from the ground up. All we're paying for is the domain name.

Speaker 4

You feel like doing any work outside for AEA for other nonprofits?

Speaker 2

Absolutely. We got a card for that. Yeah, here it is, Yeah, Just don't give it the nick That's me. Don't give it the nick Oh It's a nice card too.

Speaker 4

Thank you Thank you But don't give it the nick. So, okay, now this shows my ignorance. What do I do with this? It doesn't have anything.

Speaker 1

Tap your phone to it,; it'll launch my website and download my contact right into your cell phone. Damn,

Speaker 4

This is. Do you want this back? I can do it right now.

Speaker 1

No, keep it all yours.

Speaker 2

Don't give it to Nick because that's his cousin.

Speaker 1

Yeah, Nick's your cousin?

Speaker 4

Yeah, Nick's my cousin. Ahhh! Oh man! All right!

Speaker 1

What's next from here? Um. Agenda. Did you do so? We got a DCM report, new business. Do we have a C P C P I report?

Speaker 10

Well, we don't. No, I was on vacation for the last month, so I didn't really do anything with the CPI stuff. That is good. Yeah, exactly.

Speaker 2

That's why I am here tonight. I have some literature for you and tell you what we did.

Speaker 3

Great question: What does that stand for?

Speaker 2

Cooperation with the public and professional information. We give out Alcoholics Anonymous information. Have a nice night, nice meeting you. Yeah, and we do the libraries, professionals, doctors, magistrates, high schools—we're really big on high schools—and nursing home. We just had a Q and A, which they call it a question answer—a panel of eight AA people went in front of the. Public, and we explained the beginning of Alcoholics Anonymous and also the beginning in Pittsburgh. We had a presentation. We also had one at Carnegie Library, Carnegie PA, and it attended maybe forty some people.

Speaker 3

Okay, well I meant to ask you that we were outside. No wait, I don't know the answer to that. Hold on, I should have asked. Thank,

Speaker 2

You That is something new that people were actually doing to get out to the public. Because so many people are misled about Alcoholics Anonymous, this way, if you myself thirty three years ago, yeah, I was one of them guys probably at the magistrate getting arrested for a DUI. Well, I am there at the magistrate. I look over oh t here is a literature. I can read it. Yeah, I get court order. Oh maybe maybe it'll

work for me. But yeah that's the idea to get something in their hands and we distributed.

Speaker 2

13 libraries in our district, we distributed 13 Alcoholics Anonymous Big Books. And, the other day, we just traveled to the 13 libraries and gave them 12 and 12 publications. So anybody that can't afford, that they can't like your buddies and they don't have the funds, all they got to do is have a library card and it's free. And they put one out and they can get it. In two states,

Speaker 3

Too, our home group. If you need a big book,

Speaker 2

We just yeah we give out free big books. Most most of them do. Yeah yeah But some people just don't have it. They don't want it. They think it's charity or whatever this way, they have an opportunity to get one in their hands That's what I'm trying to help.

Speaker 3

Yeah I try to pay that case, you know, somebody needs a big book. We do like Oh.

Speaker 2

Yeah, ours does too I don't think I've ever been to a meeting that didn't offer a big book. Yeah, don't leave without one. We'll make sure one gets in your hand.

Speaker 1

Unless anybody has any other new business, we're ready to close.

Speaker 2

Great job. Thank you for letting me attend meeting. Absolutely welcome anytime here, the first Thursday of every month come back. Yeah, but sorry to tell you is my home group, and this gentleman here. Plays hockey because he's a D C L. I had these things made the willing on Saturday. I spent on there. Oh yeah, yeah, Joe's gonna drive. Yeah, I think it's just gonna be me and you. That's all right. I'll come on your house. All right, We'll figure it out how you which way you're going to go,

Speaker 3

Take one of those.

Speaker 3

If I if I can make it, I will text. She's going on Sunday, but oh okay. No, because she don't street from me.

Speaker 5

That might be thank you all for your service. You guys are making motion to close. Yep motion to close. All in favor? Aye All right so.

